National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Tallahassee, FL	**Accident Number:**	NYC08CA055
Date & Time:	12/08/2007, 1730 EST	**Registration:**	N5921D
Aircraft:	Piper PA-22-150	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	1 Minor
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The pilot, age 85, was attempting to land a Piper PA-22-150 at his private airstrip. While on final approach for the 1,500-foot-long turf strip, the airplane contacted trees, then utility wires, and came to rest upright. The reported weather about the time of the accident included calm winds, a broken ceiling at 9,000 feet, and visibility 10 miles. The pilot reported a total flight experience of 2,319 hours; of which, most was in the same make and model as the accident airplane. In addition, the pilot flew the accident airplane about 17 hours during the 90-day period preceding the accident. Examination of the wreckage did not reveal any preimpact mechanical malfunctions, nor did the pilot report any.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The pilot's misjudged clearance over obstacles during final approach.

Findings

Occurrence #1: IN FLIGHT COLLISION WITH OBJECT
Phase of Operation: APPROACH

Findings
1. OBJECT - TREE(S)
2. (C) ALTITUDE/CLEARANCE - MISJUDGED - PILOT IN COMMAND

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Private	**Age:**	85, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	Class 3 With Waivers/Limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	06/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	10/01/2006
Flight Time:	2319 hours (Total, all aircraft), 2313 hours (Total, this make and model), 2072 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 17 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 8 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 1 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Piper	**Registration:**	N5921D
Model/Series:	PA-22-150	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	22-4583
Landing Gear Type:	Tailwheel	**Seats:**	4
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	11/01/2007, Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	2000 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:	7 Hours	**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	3861 Hours at time of accident	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:	Installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-320
Registered Owner:	Willis O Forman	**Rated Power:**	
Operator:	Willis O Forman	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	TLH, 81 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	19 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	1753 EST	**Direction from Accident Site:**	270°
Lowest Cloud Condition:		**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	Broken / 9000 ft agl	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	Calm /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:		**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.27 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	22°C / 17°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Quincy, FL (2J9)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Tallahassee, FL (NONE)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	1710 EST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	Private Airstrip (NONE)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Grass/turf
Airport Elevation:		**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	12	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	1500 ft / 75 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Full Stop; Straight-in

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 Minor	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 Minor	**Latitude, Longitude:**	30.501111, -84.080278

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Robert J Gretz	**Report Date:**	01/31/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	Thomas Gross; FAA/FSDO; Orlando, FL		
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

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The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.